



NETIZENS IN DIGITAL WORLD

K6A6W4

Learning Outcome

After this lesson, learners will be able to:

- Understand the concept of digital society and its characteristics.
- Know about netizens and their rights.
- Understand the netizen mission.
- Understand about digital citizenship and its significance.
- Identify the categories to safeguard Digital citizenship.

Today's world is a digital world. Everything is online. People shop online, students are studying online, talents are displayed on online platforms, people collect information about almost anything, and even go online to talk to friends, do meetings, transactions etc. Today none of us can even imagine a world without the internet, smartphones, tablets, electronic games and other handheld devices. It has significantly influenced people's thinking and learning abilities.



Digitalization promises tremendous benefits for better health, more efficient mobility, efficient energy use, and flourishing companies.

Thus, the rise in the use of digital technologies in all areas of human endeavor is reflected in the development of the digital society.

1.1 DIGITAL SOCIETY

Digital society refers to an upcoming, modern society that is formed by using advanced technology at home, work, education, and recreation, all supported by telecommunication and wireless connectivity systems.



However, we need to understand how the scale and speed of these technological changes are affecting internet citizens.

The process of informationalization provides an opportunity for rural society to communicate with the whole world, work in the most prestigious organizations, and be a part of cultural achievements.

Characteristics of Digital Society

- best use of all digital resources
- links individuals and groups together
- sharing a digital platform for collaborative innovation
- provides online Learning opportunity



DIGITAL SOCIETY DAY is celebrated every year on 17th October.

Digital citizens belong to the digital society. They actively participate in and contribute to society via technology.

1.2 NETIZENS OR DIGITAL CITIZEN

Anyone who uses digital technology with the Internet is a digital citizen or netizen. The word Netizen is derived from Internet citizen.

INTERNET + CITIZEN

A good netizen uses digital technology in a safe, ethical, and legal manner. A responsible internet user must adhere to internet, communication and social media etiquettes.

The term Netizen was coined by Michael Hauben in 1995, a graduate student of Columbia University, U.S.A., at that time.

The online environment should be a safe space in which everyone feels protected. Thus, every netizen should be responsible for any type of technological use, ensuring the safety of the online environment for generations to come.

The cyber-world will be a safe and healthy space only when all users understand the meaning and importance of netiquette. Always keep in mind that the people you are interacting with online are actual humans!

Remember the Golden Rule

Treat others the way you wish to be treated.

1.2.1 Digital Rights of Netizen

- Right to freedom of expression
- Right to privacy
- Right to credit for personal works
- Right to digital access
- Right to identity



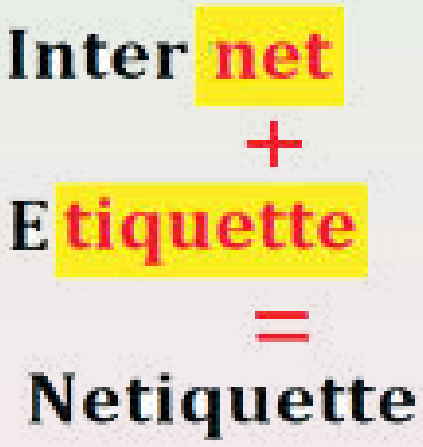
A good netizen always tries to make the world of digital networks a better place to survive. One should follow the given rules to become a safe, secure and sensible netizen in this modern era.



1.3 NETIZEN MISSION

As a Digital Society, it is our responsibility to provide the opportunity to work, interact, and use technology without the interference, destruction, or obstruction by any user.

Therefore, a netizen's mission is to create a society of users that strive to use technology appropriately. With new online horizons and shift to online education, the Netiquettes are needed even more today!



Netiquette is derived from the two words

Netiquette means the set of rules to communicate with an individual or a group on the internet. It includes proper manners for sending e-mail, conversing online, and so on.

Every Citizen must follow the netiquettes to become **a safe, secure and sensible netizen** of the country.



1.4 DIGITAL CITIZENSHIP

Digital citizenship is the responsible use of technology by anyone who interacts with society using computers, the internet, and digital devices. It depicts how an individual can explore securely, morally, and suitably on the World Wide Web.

Importance of Digital citizenship

As everyone with an internet connection is a digital citizen, the concept of digital citizenship becomes a critical part of our lives. People of all ages need to know how to stay safe, respect others, and participate meaningfully in the digital world.

In **July 2015**, the government launched the '**Digital India**' initiative to improve online infrastructure and increase internet access among its citizens; so that the digital citizens of the country can be empowered.



There are three categories to safeguard digital citizenship.

- Respect
- Educate
- Protect

Respect

Digital access: Support Netizens for equal digital rights and access is where digital citizenship starts.

Digital etiquette: Teach everyone how to behave in an online environment.

Digital law: Advanced digital Laws have been made to regulate and govern the digital activities.

Educate

Digital communication: One must know how to communicate on the digital platform with a variety of interacting tools available.

Digital literacy: Digital literacy helps the person to understand the activities performed by the digital citizen.

Digital commerce: To become a responsible digital citizen, one must know how to perform online transactions with safety.

Protect

Digital rights and responsibilities: One must know the primary digital rights to privacy, and freedom of speech.

Digital safety and security: Netizen must know how to safeguard the data present online.

Digital health and wellness: One imperative angle of living in an advanced world is knowing when to unplug. One must use digital technology to take care of health by doing online exercise and other related activities.





Every year, the third week of October is coined as the Digital Citizenship Week.

ASSESSMENT

Q1. Read the scenario carefully and mark the appropriate netiquette to be followed:

1. During a group video call with friends, one of the students started a loud conversation. Is it okay to talk loudly during a group call at a public place?

   A. No, one should be respectful

   B. No problem in talking loudly

   C. No, one should be safe

Ans: A. No, one should be respectful

2. Avinash forgot to complete his homework and, in the morning, he remembered that he had to complete his assignment. He immediately opened the laptop, logged in to a website, and copied/pasted information. Is it ethical to use internet material without giving credit to the authors?

   A. No, one should be respectful

   B. No, one should be safe

   C. No, it's not ethical

   D. None of the above

Ans: C. No, it's not ethical

3. Garima received a fascinating lottery link in her email. She clicked the link and it started downloading a malicious script, releasing a virus on her computer. Is it okay to download content from unknown sites?

   A. No, one should be respectful

   B. No, one should try to be safe

C. No, one should not be ethical

D. None of the above

Ans: B. No, one should try to be safe

Q2. Match the given scenarios with the elements of Digital citizenship:

1. While learning technology in school, it is important for you to know the rules of using technology and how to online work with others ethically.

2. Shopping from any popular app on the Internet, you should think twice about buying online, because shoping site may be dangerous.

3. While interacting with people across the world one should not give any sensitive information to anyone, no matter what the reason is.

Digital commerce

Digital Security

Digital Learning

Ans: 1. Digital Learning

2. Digital Commerce

3. Digital Security